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Gadgets to die for, or kill for, depending on the way you look at it!

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As we headed into the year 2010, the general opinion was that netbooks would rule the portable computer market, thanks to their affordable price and the expected increase in power and performance. What actually happened was what happens to many a stubborn army, resting too much on their laurels sees them vanquished in the end. Netbook makers seemed to be arrogant, and didn't really improve on performance or features, and as a result, they were flanked and outclassed – although the war rages on, the battle of the day was lost?

whose most destructive weapon was its OS that was designed for tablets from the ground up, the Galaxy tab had to struggle a bit with a more modest weapon – Android 2.2 (Froyo) OS – which was built for mobile phones.

Another aspect of armoury that was very different was the fact that the Apple iPad had a 10.1-inch screen, whilst the Samsung Galaxy Tab had a smaller 7-inch screen. Whilst Apple boasted of capturing larger screen area, Samsung touted the more manoeuvrable form factor of its device.

Relationships broke down, and the tablet army was forever plunged into a debate of whether a 10-inch screen is better than a 7-inch one – tempers still flare easily to this day.

Windows Phone 7

Is it any competition to Android, or not? Flip over to the article and find out...



Apple's iPad 2

2011:

The year of the tablet?

The rise of the tablets has happened at breakneck speed. Read on to know about what may happen

HEAVY ARTILLERY**The Apple iPad**

The launch of the Apple iPad (in April, 2010) took the netbook world by surprise, and inevitably, a slew of Apple-me-toos slid into the market. The tablet is a concept that has been around since the 1960s, however, it took Apple to generate excitement about the category and post impressive sales figures. Two things happened; first, there was a hole the size of China that opened up, splitting the hapless army of netbooks and laptops in twain – a completely new genre of gadgets caught our fancy. Second, the me-toos attacked in full force, and rode into that gap, virtually unopposed.

FIGHTING IN THE RANKS**My screen's bigger than yours!**

Samsung was the most aggressive attacker, led by the now famous general, the Galaxy Tab. Ill equipped when compared to Apple's one-man-army,

THE CLONE WARS**Borg vs. Borg**

Manufacturers attempted to use their choice of operating system as a means of differentiating their tablet from their rival's. What started out as a mere military action between Apple's iOS and Android – courtesy the iPad vs. Galaxy Tab – quickly scaled to a full blown war with everyone using the same weapon to try and annihilate the competition. It soon became a race to be the first to offer the latest Android version on a tablet. The fact that Android has since seen major updates from 2.2 (Froyo) to 2.3 (Ginger-

bread, in December 2010) and now 3.0 (Honeycomb, February 2011), and this did not help the early adopters much. Many a civilian casualty were witnessed.

The problem was, as we said earlier, that Android was never really built



The HP TouchPad